DECISION MEMORANDUM

Everstead equipment diversion — operating decision

To: Karin Sheridan and cross-functional internal stakeholders | Decision required: Friday, 13 June 2025 | Factual position: 12 June 2025

DECISION — AUTHORISE STAGED, INTELLIGENCE-LED INVESTIGATION
Start immediate preservation and proportionate operational controls now. Do not move to targeted interviews, identity disclosure, disciplinary action, or a guilt conclusion on the interview allegation and access overlap alone. Karin Sheridan owns the 13 June checkpoint.

What is established / what is not

Supplied record	Decision significance
18 units in three dispatch lots; **11** reconciled; **7** unaccounted. Client-recorded replacement exposure: **£31,800**.	Fixed baseline: 18 – 11 = 7. It establishes impact, not responsibility.
Same CB-EXC ledger exception across the lots; three badge events overlap relevant collection windows.	**Actionable intelligence / records to test.** Neither record identifies handling or redirection.
Witness reports that Employee A said Employee B arranged a redirection. Witness did not see or independently verify it.	**Uncorroborated second-hand allegation — a lead only.** It is not evidence of guilt or a finding.
Access permission remains active through scheduled collection on 16 June; last known event was 4 June.	Plausible continuing operational concern; control proportionately while facts are secured.

Assessment and recommendation

Both readings are defensible. Rapid targeted interviews could disrupt a live concern and generate accounts quickly; they also risk alerting people, contaminating recollection, unfairness, and pressure to disclose a name before the records are tested. A staged approach is slower to a person-specific answer but preserves provenance, tests the common exception and access overlap, and contains the 16 June concern through existing, proportionate operational arrangements. **Choose staged investigation**: at this evidential stage its fairness and rework advantages outweigh the speed benefit, provided it has the firm 13 June review below.

Assumptions used for the option model: the common exception and access records can be preserved and reviewed before the 13 June checkpoint; existing operational controls can be assessed without asserting new powers; and any interview is only considered after a documented review. These are professional planning assumptions, not observed case facts.

Options and projected consequences

Dimension	Rapid targeted interviews	Staged intelligence-led investigation — selected
Speed / operational effect	Can obtain accounts quickly and may signal disruption. It could also alert a person before ledger/access material is secured.	Begin preservation and operational control immediately; reach a documented evidence review by 13 June. More measured path to a person-specific step.
Information / evidence position	Interview accounts may create new leads, but early questioning can affect later recall and does not cure the second-hand allegation.	Original ledger, access exports and interview note are retained and compared for provenance, timing and alternative explanations before escalation.
Fairness / client risk	Higher risk of an allegation being treated as proof, premature adverse action or impermissible identity sharing under client pressure.	Lower disclosure and rework risk; client receives a candid status reset rather than an unsupported name.
Principal downside	Potentially unfair, less reliable process and harder-to-repair client/employee harm.	If controls are inadequate or review drifts, the active access period may leave operational exposure insufficiently managed.
Scenario model	Weighted planning score: 62 / 105 (assumption-based).	Weighted planning score: 92 / 105 (assumption-based); supports selection, not a finding.

Required safeguards and boundaries

• **Evidence gate.** No identity is disclosed to Everstead, no disciplinary/adverse action is initiated, and no guilt conclusion is recorded solely from the second-hand allegation or badge overlap. Before a stronger step, Karin must record independent verification/corroboration relevant to the proposed step and obtain HR/Legal advice where employment or disclosure consequences arise.

• **Record integrity.** Preserve original dispatch ledger extracts for all three CB-EXC lots, relevant access records, the interview note and available metadata; record source, collector, date/time, access and any working copy. Restrict editing and keep a retrieval log.

• **Fair process.** If a targeted interview is later necessary, use impartial, non-accusatory questions; give a genuine opportunity to respond; make a reliable contemporaneous record; and arrange appropriate HR advice/representation safeguards where applicable. A private corporate inquiry has no automatic police powers of search, seizure or compelled interview.

• **England information handling.** Treat identities and investigative material as personal data: use a lawful, fair and proportionate purpose; minimise access and share on need-to-know only. UK GDPR / Data Protection Act 2018 and employment-process issues require competent HR/Legal advice; do not imply that the client request creates authority to disclose.

Authorisation and changed operating position

Owner	Authorised action / boundary	When / review
Karin Sheridan Decision owner	Authorises the staged posture and evidence gate. Directs custody of the review record; decides at checkpoint whether any person-specific step is necessary and proportionate.	**By 16:00, Fri 13 Jun.** Stop/hold a targeted interview or disclosure if the material remains only allegation plus overlap, or if integrity/fairness cannot be assured.
Records custodian Role owner	Preserve/export the specified ledger, access and interview records; record provenance and access. Assess existing operational arrangements for the 16 Jun collection — no assertion of new authority and no allegation-based sanction.	**By 12:00, Fri 13 Jun.** Escalate promptly to Karin if a record cannot be secured or operational control cannot be assessed.
Chidi Trevelyan Client liaison	Reset Everstead's expectation: provide a status and safeguarding update, but no suspected identity. State that names are not shared absent a substantiated, necessary and appropriately authorised basis.	**By 13:00, Fri 13 Jun.** Log the communication; refer any challenge to Karin and HR/Legal review.

OPERATING POSITION CHANGED
From: "share suspected staff identities quickly."
To: "preserve and test intelligence; provide Everstead a status update only; hold identities, adverse action and conclusions behind a documented corroboration, necessity and authority gate."

Decision record: This authorisation is an internal operational decision, not a finding of misconduct or criminality. It does not create police powers or decide any employment outcome. The staged course is proportionate to the fixed incident baseline, the unresolved status of seven units, the active access concern and the current evidential limits.